Property Deed

From the zawiya of Sulayman Misu in al-Tarbi'a

Fatimid, 4th century AH / 10th century CE

Wood

W: 362 cm; H: 26 cm

Inv. no. 3555/1-5



"In the name of God, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. {This was granted by the grace of my Lord, to test me, to give thanks, or to be ungrateful. Whoever gives thanks does so for the benefit of his own soul; whoever is ungrateful, my Lord is self-sufficient and generous.} He has bestowed the shop, with all its boundaries and rights, above and below, upon His servant Omar ibn Salama ibn Sulayman al-'Attar, as a gift from His abundant grace and generosity."

A long wooden frieze in five fragments, bearing a Kufic inscription in two registers. The text reads (trans.): "In the name of God, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. This was granted by the grace of my Lord, to test me, to give thanks, or to be ungrateful. Whoever gives thanks does so for the benefit of his own soul; whoever is ungrateful, my Lord is self-sufficient and Generous. He has bestowed the shop, with all its boundaries and rights, above and below, upon His servant Omar ibn Salama ibn Sulayman al-'Attar, as a gift from His abundant grace and generosity." Small curling leaves occasionally emerge from the letters, suggesting an early, modest form of floriated Kufic associated with the Fatimid period.

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